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To Whom It May Concern

Re: Reference for Joel Amaldas

It is with pleasure that I write this letter of reference for Joel Amaldas. Joel is a confident, articulate and capable young person.

Joel volunteers as a member of our Child and Youth Advisory Council (CAYAC) at the Alberta Children's Hospital. He started this role in September 2023. The Council, made up of youth ages 12-21, provides a youth voice for child health programs and services. This work is done primarily during six yearly Saturday meetings. Joel demonstrates a strong commitment to support the work of the Council. He is very consistent in attending our meetings.

Joel is an active, engaged participant in CAYAC meetings. He has demonstrated an ability to critically reflect on the consultations brought to the meetings and to provide thoughtful, constructive ideas and feedback based on his own lived experience. Joel is respectful of others and engages well with our diverse membership.

Our council has a shared leadership model and Joel has stepped forward to be a co-chair on one occasion. He is articulate and confident in this role. He has also participated several times in our Patient and Family Centred Care Advisory Network by responding to email requests for input/feedback to provide the youth perspective.

Over the past three years, I have seen Joel's collaborative and leadership skills grow. Based on my interactions with him, I believe he will make strong contributions to his work and community, regardless of the direction his future holds.

If I can provide any further information, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Sincerely

Marie McNaughton B.H.E. M.Ed.
Family and Youth Engagement Coordinator
Coordinator – Child and Youth Advisory Council (CAYAC)
Alberta Children's Hospital